



FEEDBACK

Article on Solar

Please publish more articles on the different types of solar methods available for harnessing solar energy, availability of solar panels in India, government subsidies and various schemes available for installing solar panels at home, cost for installing 4kWh to 5kWh solar panels, solar panels without the battery and the like.

R.L. Joshi

Surat, Gujarat

EFY: Thanks for writing to us! We have been publishing articles related to solar in *Electronics For You* twice every year since 2009, almost regularly. If you are interested, we can forward the list of the published articles to you.

First Look Section

You always cover mobiles, cameras and other gadgets in First Look section. Please include an affordable laptop in this section.

Ismail Taibani

Through email

EFY: Thanks for the feedback! We will try to cover affordable laptops in First Look section, as and when an interesting one is launched.

Muscle Stimulator

The 'Low-Frequency Electronic Muscle Stimulator' published in July issue is no doubt an interesting one but I have the following comments:

1. This is purely an amateur circuit. There is no galvanic isolation with the output, which is very unsafe. Practical circuits are complex but much safer. So a word of caution should have been mentioned at the end of the article.

2. Transformer X2 should not be a normal transformer and, in this case, it heats up excessively after a few minutes of running this circuit, as the frequency it handles is not AC sine-wave. The transformer should be of higher rating, and the core and

'Spot An Error' Award Winners

In 'AVR Based Programmable Object Counter' DIY article published in August issue, RST pin of the microcontroller is active-low, so reset switch S1 circuitry should be connected to ground instead of +5V supply.

Maykan Patel

□ In 'Solar-Powered Kennel Light' DIY article published in August issue, in Figs 2 and 4, solar panel rating at CON1 is wrongly written as 6V, 100E, instead of 6V, 100mA.

Prashanth Nayak

Errata

In 'American Carrier Strike Groups: An Electronic Perspective (Part 1 of 5)' article published in September issue, on page 72, third column, fourth paragraph, the correct statement would be 'Further to cement the importance of air defence, the USSR (of which the present day Russia was a part) entered into the picture as the newfound adversary of the USA to fight Cold War, a war fought without pulling a shot.'

□ There are some typographical errors in 'Android based RC Charging and Discharging' article published in July issue. In Fig. 1, on page 105, charging time (ST) should be read as charging time (5T). In the third column, 1000e-6 should be read as either 1000E-6 or 1000μ, and the value of I_{max} should be 0.0003A instead of 0.003A.

winding design should not create any distortion in output wave form.

3. This kind of stimulator may cause harm because output wave shape is unknown.

Uttam Dutta

Assistant manager,

Tata Steel Ltd, Jamshedpur

The author K. Murali Krishna replies: Thank you for your interest in the article!

1. Since this is a simple circuit, galvanic isolation is not considered. Instead of going for isolation transformers, you can use a 2x9V battery in series at TP1 by removing transformer X1 setup.

Practical circuits are more complicated, but the difference is that, in place of IC LM555, there will be a programmed IC that produces different patterns of rectangular waveforms and PWM signals of different customised patterns. It can be used for medical purposes under medical supervision, which is mentioned at the end of the article.

2. As R6 (4.7-kilo-ohm) limits the base current of T1, a small collector current flows through T1. So X2 will not heat up and we can use a

normal transformer.

3. Use of this circuit under medical supervision is a must. Most electrotherapy equipment produce narrow rectangular pulses. The circuit also produces narrow rectangular pulses of the order of 70V-90V.

EFY Plus DVD

Thanks for your KTechlab information included in EFY Plus DVD section in September 2014 issue! I downloaded KTechlab from its official website, but there is no setup or .exe file in the folder. Please help me install the same.

Prakash Bantanur

Through email

EFY: KTechlab does not have any .exe file for installation. It is available mainly for installation on Linux and Unix-like operating systems (OSes). In order to install the file, you can follow the steps given in 'How to Install KTechlab' section in September 2014 issue. Although it is mentioned on many websites that nowadays we can find KTechlab version that is compatible with Windows OS, we have been unable to find one till date.